

Tracks are flexible and the layout also supports differential pair routing. As you route your circuit, signal lines are dynamically quantified. Run a design rule check, and check if your design is correct. Generate data in whatever format or package variant you require by defining the programming language.

Offering the support you might need

Registered EAGLE customers are always free to write to the technical team at their respective locations, the email ids of which can be found on their website. A frequently asked questions (FAQ) page (www.cadsoftusa.com/training-service/faq) and a forum (www.cadsoftusa.com/community) aids in solving user queries. A download area (www.cadsoftusa.com/downloads/libraries) provides links to all their latest releases.

CadSoft also provides online trainings, webinars, videos and tutorials to help you work with the software, the details of which can also be found on their website.

You can purchase the software online by logging into CadSoft website (www.cadsoftusa.com). Once bought, upgrades, licence renewal, additions like the library, projects and so on require minimal effort.

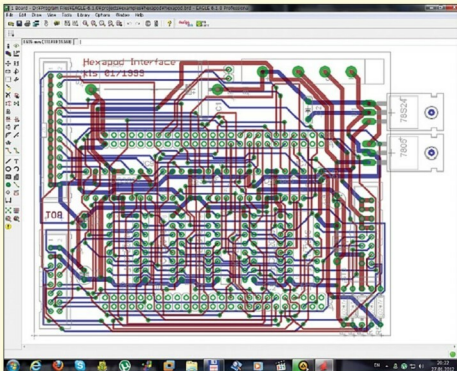


Fig. 4: Be your layout's architect (Image courtesy: thegioitinhoc.vn/do-hoa)

Decide if this is the right tool for you by becoming familiar with the limited version. All you need to do is install the setup from the DVD and explore. The same is also available on the official website as EAGLE Light Edition.

Users and their views

EAGLE seems to be getting mixed reviews. While it has its own set of loyal customers who have been using it for years, some users seem to pre-

fer other software like KiCad, Circuit Wizard and Design Spark.

What makes EAGLE kick for the loyalists is the free version (limited only by the size of the board), support and response from CadSoft to their queries, the fact that there is information aplenty available about EAGLE and strong support from PCB manufacturers.

The problem areas have been the language in the UI; terms used seem to convey meanings other than intended, like usage of 'drop' for 'hide' and such. There are also some complaints about the software being a little tedious to learn initially, but once you spend that initial time, you seem to have learnt the trick.

Well, a software application that is a winner of awards and one that has so many regular users, including commercial PCB designers and professionals, must have something right in it. With the tool being upgraded with every new release, it is left to you to try this for yourself and arrive at a verdict. Write to us about your take on EAGLE, after using it. ●

Quotes courtesy: www.newark.com/cadsoft

"Each module you can imagine, starting with a simple power adaptor via the motor-control module, up to the battery management system developed in-house, is developed by using EAGLE. In this case, EAGLE is a one-stop solution. First, it can be used to create circuit plans and layouts, ranging from simple to complex. EAGLE makes it child's play to optimise the size of the board or the general arrangement of components. Since elements such as the required training period and efficiency (one program for all) are our top priority and the setup has allowed all students, even those without any previous knowledge, to get to grips with the operation in just a few hours, EAGLE software package from CadSoft has become a standard tool, which we cannot do without."

—Sarah Schwöbel, *municHMotorsport*

"What I like most about EAGLE is the flexibility it offers. With EAGLE ULPs, there is no limit to what I can create [in terms of] designing PCB boards!"

—Thomas Benoit, *SERELEC*

"I design my boards using EAGLE, buy components via the integrated DesignLink and get these produced with the offered PCB fabrication service. This is just great!"

—Electronics engineer